

Yoruba Lessons 1-4 Lean Review Package

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Scripts and words taught only. Draft scripts for native Yoruba review.

Lesson 1

Script

Track 1 — How to Work

Teacher: Welcome. Before we touch Yoruba, I want to set the rules of the game.

Teacher: I will ask you to build something. When I ask, pause the audio. Don't rush. Say your answer out loud. Then come back and listen.

Teacher: If you answer slowly, that is not a problem. That is the method working. Fast guessing feels nice, but slow thinking builds the language.

Teacher: And don't try to memorize. If you catch yourself thinking, "Do I remember this phrase?", gently move away from that. We are going to build the phrase again from smaller pieces.

Teacher: Good. Yoruba now.

Track 2 — The Voice Skill

Teacher: Yoruba is going to ask your voice to do something it already knows how to do.

Teacher: Hum one note, any note, and hold it.

[pause]

Teacher: Good. Now hum a higher note and hold it. Don't slide up to it like a question. Just land there and stay there.

[pause]

Teacher: Good. Now a lower note. Hold that one too.

[pause]

Teacher: That's the useful skill. Not singing. Not performing. Just letting your voice sit somewhere.

Teacher: English uses pitch mostly for attitude: surprise, doubt, a question, maybe sarcasm if you're feeling dramatic. Yoruba can use pitch as part of the word itself.

Teacher: So today, don't try to understand the whole tone system. That would be too much. Just copy where the voice sits.

Track 3 — I

Teacher: The Yoruba word for “I” is **mo**. Mo.

Teacher: Listen once: mo.

Teacher: Now say it.

Student: Mo.

Teacher: Good. Mo. Small word, middle of the voice. Don't lean on it. It just opens the door for the rest of the sentence.

Teacher: Again: mo.

Student: Mo.

Teacher: Good. Mo.

Track 4 — Want

Teacher: The word for “want” is **fẹ**. Fẹ.

Teacher: Listen before you say it. My voice is sitting higher there: fẹ.

Teacher: Try it.

Student: Fẹ.

Teacher: Good. Fẹ. If it came out a little flat, don't wrestle with it. Just listen again: mo ... fẹ. Middle, then higher.

Teacher: Mo means I. Fẹ means want.

Teacher: Build it in two pieces. How would you say “I want”?

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ.

Teacher: Yes. Mo fẹ.

Teacher: Good because you did not search for a whole phrase. You put the two pieces next to each other.

Teacher: Say it once more and let the second piece sit higher.

Student: Mo fẹ.

Teacher: Good. Mo fẹ.

Track 5 — Water

Teacher: The word for water is **omi**. Omi.

Teacher: Two little beats, both comfortable in the middle of the voice. Omi.

Teacher: Say it.

Student: Omi.

Teacher: Good. Omi. Now don't remember a phrase. Build it.

Teacher: First the frame: I want.

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ.

Teacher: Good. Mo fẹ. Now add water. "I want water."

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ omi.

Teacher: Good. Mo fẹ omi. You kept the frame still and only changed the ending. That's the habit we want.

Teacher: Notice also there was no word for "a." English might say "a water" in some situations, or "some water." Yoruba didn't ask us for that here. Just the thing: omi.

Teacher: Again. "I want water."

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ omi.

Teacher: Good. Mo fẹ omi.

Track 6 — Food

Teacher: The word for food is **oúnjẹ**. Oúnjẹ.

Teacher: Listen first. Oúnjẹ.

Teacher: Try it slowly.

Student: Oúnjẹ.

Teacher: Good. Oúnjẹ. If your mouth felt busier there, that's fine. We are not stopping to study every sound. We are just using the word in the frame.

Teacher: How would you say "I want food"?

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ oúnjẹ.

Teacher: Yes. Mo fẹ óúnjẹ.

Teacher: What stayed still?

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ.

Teacher: Exactly. Mo fẹ. The frame stayed still.

Teacher: Now swap only the last piece. “I want water.”

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ omi.

Teacher: Good. Mo fẹ omi.

Teacher: “I want food.”

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ óúnjẹ.

Teacher: Good. Mo fẹ óúnjẹ. That is not memorizing. That is control.

Track 7 — Eat

Teacher: Sometimes you want a thing. Water. Food.

Teacher: Sometimes you want to do something. English puts a little “to” there: I want to eat.

Teacher: English is going to try to donate that “to” to Yoruba. Don’t accept the gift. Yoruba didn’t ask for it here.

Teacher: The word for eat is **jẹun**. Jẹun.

Teacher: Say it.

Student: Jẹun.

Teacher: Good. Jẹun. So take it in two pieces. First, “I want.”

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ.

Teacher: Good. Mo fẹ.

Teacher: Now add eat. “I want to eat.”

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ jẹun.

Teacher: Good. Mo fẹ jẹun.

Possible learner mistake: Mo fẹ to jeun.

Teacher: If you felt that English “to” trying to sneak in, excellent, notice it. That’s exactly where English interferes. Go back to the Yoruba frame: mo fẹ, then the action. Mo fẹ jeun.

Teacher: Again. “I want to eat.”

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ jeun.

Teacher: Good. Mo fẹ jeun.

Track 8 — Sleep

Teacher: One more action. Listen before you say this one.

Teacher: Sùn. Sùn.

Teacher: Let your voice sit low and stay there. Sùn.

Teacher: Try it.

Student: Sùn.

Teacher: Good. Sùn. Now build “I want to sleep.”

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ sùn.

Teacher: Yes. Mo fẹ sùn.

Teacher: Listen to the little path your voice just walked: mo, middle. Fẹ, higher. Sùn, lower. Three small pieces, and each one has its own place.

Teacher: We are not making a chart of tones. We are letting your ear begin to trust itself.

Track 9 — Mixed Building

Teacher: Now I will mix things and actions. Your job is always the same: find the frame, then add the ending.

Teacher: “I want water.”

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ omi.

Teacher: Good. Mo fẹ omi. The frame held.

Teacher: “I want to eat.”

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ jẹun.

Teacher: Good. Mo fẹ jẹun. No English “to.”

Teacher: “I want food.”

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ ounjẹ.

Teacher: Good. Mo fẹ ounjẹ.

Teacher: “I want to sleep.”

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ sùn.

Teacher: Very good. Mo fẹ sùn. Let’s do a quicker round, but not rushed. Quick thinking is still thinking.

Teacher: “I want food.”

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ ounjẹ.

Teacher: Good. Mo fẹ ounjẹ.

Teacher: “I want water.”

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ omi.

Teacher: Good. Mo fẹ omi.

Teacher: “I want to sleep.”

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ sùn.

Teacher: Good. Mo fẹ sùn.

Teacher: “I want to eat.”

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ jẹun.

Teacher: Good. Mo fẹ jẹun.

Track 10 — Close

Teacher: Good. Let’s stop before we get greedy.

Teacher: You have one engine now:

Teacher: Mo fẹ ...

Teacher: Mo fẹ omi. I want water.

Teacher: Mo fẹ oúnjẹ. I want food.

Teacher: Mo fẹ jẹun. I want to eat.

Teacher: Mo fẹ sùn. I want to sleep.

Teacher: The win is not four phrases. The win is that the frame stayed still while you changed the ending.

Teacher: Next time, we will keep this frame and get more control. No new mountain. Just stronger footing.

Words Taught

Yoruba Meaning

mo	I
fẹ	want
omi	water
oúnjẹ	food
jẹun	eat
sùn	sleep

Lesson 2

Script

Track 1 — Rebuild, Don't Remember

Teacher: Welcome back. We are going to do something very useful today: almost nothing new.

Teacher: That may sound disappointing, but it is actually where a language starts becoming yours.

Teacher: Don't try to remember the phrases from Lesson 1. Rebuild them.

Teacher: What was the little frame for "I want"?

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ.

Teacher: Good. Mo fẹ. You found the frame.

Teacher: Now add water. "I want water."

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ omi.

Teacher: Good. Mo fẹ omi. Now sleep. “I want to sleep.”

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ sùn.

Teacher: Yes. Mo fẹ sùn. And notice, no panic if it took a moment. The moment you spent rebuilding is the useful part.

Track 2 — The Frame Holds

Teacher: Say just the frame again.

Student: Mo fẹ.

Teacher: Good. Mo fẹ. That is our little machine.

Teacher: Food was **óúnjẹ**. So “I want food.”

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ óúnjẹ.

Teacher: Good. Mo fẹ óúnjẹ.

Teacher: Eat was **jẹun**. “I want to eat.”

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ jẹun.

Teacher: Good. Mo fẹ jẹun. What changed between those two answers?

[pause]

Student: The ending.

Teacher: Exactly. The ending. The ending changed. The frame did not. This is the kind of boring observation that becomes very powerful if you keep making it.

Track 3 — Go

Teacher: A new action now. The word for go is **lọ**. Lọ.

Teacher: Listen. Lọ. Low voice. Let it sit low.

Teacher: Try it.

Student: Lọ.

Teacher: Good. Lọ. Build “I want to go.”

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ lọ.

Teacher: Yes. Mo fẹ lọ.

Possible learner mistake: Mo fẹ to lọ.

Teacher: If English gave you a little “to” there, that is the old habit doing its job. We just don’t hire it for Yoruba here. Mo fẹ lọ.

Teacher: Again. “I want to go.”

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ lọ.

Teacher: Good. Mo fẹ lọ.

Track 4 — Come

Teacher: The word for come is **wá**. Wá.

Teacher: This one sits higher. Wá.

Teacher: Try it.

Student: Wá.

Teacher: Good. Wá. Now build “I want to come.”

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ wá.

Teacher: Yes. Mo fẹ wá.

Teacher: Let’s keep the contrast alive.

Teacher: “I want to go.”

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ lọ.

Teacher: Good. Mo fẹ lọ.

Teacher: “I want to come.”

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ wá.

Teacher: Good. Mo fẹ wá. Low ending, high ending. Same frame.

Track 5 — Money

Teacher: One new thing. The word for money is **owó**. Owó.

Teacher: Listen first: owó.

Teacher: Try it.

Student: Owó.

Teacher: Good. Owó. Now, maybe this sentence is a little too honest, but it is structurally useful. “I want money.”

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ owó.

Teacher: Good. Mo fẹ owó.

Teacher: We will let a native speaker tell us if this is too blunt as a beginner sentence. For now, it helps us keep practicing a thing after fẹ.

Track 6 — Things and Actions

Teacher: Let’s sort the endings without using grammar words.

Teacher: Omi. Water. A thing.

Teacher: Owó. Money. A thing.

Teacher: Lọ. Go. An action.

Teacher: Wá. Come. An action.

Teacher: Yoruba lets us keep the frame steady for both.

Teacher: “I want water.”

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ omi.

Teacher: Good. Mo fẹ omi.

Teacher: “I want to go.”

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ lọ.

Teacher: Good. Mo fẹ lọ.

Teacher: “I want money.”

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ owó.

Teacher: Good. Mo fẹ owó.

Teacher: “I want to come.”

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ wá.

Teacher: Good. Mo fẹ wá. You are not learning a list. You are learning what the frame can tolerate.

Track 7 — A Useful Trap

Teacher: Listen to the English for a moment.

Teacher: I want water.

Teacher: I want money.

Teacher: I want to sleep.

Teacher: I want to go.

Teacher: English changes its little furniture depending on what follows. Yoruba, here, stays calmer.

Teacher: Mo fẹ omi.

Teacher: Mo fẹ owó.

Teacher: Mo fẹ sùn.

Teacher: Mo fẹ lọ.

Teacher: This is why we are drilling one frame. We want your mind to trust it before we ask it to do anything heavier.

Track 8 — Final Round

Teacher: Final round. Build each one from the frame.

Teacher: “I want to sleep.”

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ sùn.

Teacher: Good. Mo fẹ sùn. Low ending.

Teacher: “I want money.”

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ owó.

Teacher: Good. Mo fẹ owó.

Teacher: “I want to come.”

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ wá.

Teacher: Good. Mo fẹ wá. You kept fẹ high even while thinking about the new word.

Teacher: “I want water.”

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ omi.

Teacher: Good. Mo fẹ omi.

Teacher: “I want to go.”

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ lọ.

Teacher: Good. Mo fẹ lọ.

Teacher: “I want food.”

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ óunjẹ.

Teacher: Good. Mo fẹ óunjẹ.

Teacher: “I want to eat.”

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ jẹun.

Teacher: Good. Mo fẹ jẹun.

Track 9 — Close

Teacher: Good. Today was not about collecting many words. It was about finding the same path again and again without it feeling like memorization.

Teacher: Mo fẹ omi. Mo fẹ lọ. Mo fẹ owó. Mo fẹ wá.

Teacher: Next lesson, we change the person at the front. The verb will stay still, which is a small mercy and we will absolutely take it.

Words Taught

Yoruba Meaning

lọ go

wá come

owó money

Lesson 3

Script

Track 1 — Rebuild the Machine

Teacher: Welcome back. First, prove to yourself that the frame is still there.

Teacher: What was “I want”?

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ.

Teacher: Good. Mo fẹ. “I want water.”

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ omi.

Teacher: Good. Mo fẹ omi.

Teacher: “I want to go.”

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ lọ.

Teacher: Good. Mo fẹ lọ. You rebuilt, you didn’t rummage around for a memorized phrase. That is the skill.

Track 2 — The Front Does the Work

Teacher: Today we change the front of the sentence.

Teacher: In English, listen:

Teacher: I want.

Teacher: You want.

Teacher: Nothing happened to “want.” Only “I” became “you.”

Teacher: Good news: Yoruba is going to let us do something very similar here.

Track 3 — Familiar You

Teacher: The Yoruba word for “you,” talking to one person in a familiar way, is **o**. O.

Teacher: Listen: o.

Teacher: Try it.

Student: O.

Teacher: Good. O. Small word, middle of the voice.

Teacher: Now, careful. This is a familiar “you.” Useful, but not for everyone in the family. Yoruba cares about respect, and we will give you that respectful form soon.

Teacher: For today, imagine a sibling, a cousin, a friend. One person, familiar: o.

Track 4 — You Want

Teacher: Build this in two pieces.

Teacher: First, what is “you”?

[pause]

Student: O.

Teacher: Good. O. Now add want. “You want.”

[pause]

Student: O fẹ.

Teacher: Yes. O fẹ.

Teacher: What stayed still from Mo fẹ?

[pause]

Student: Fẹ.

Teacher: Exactly. Fẹ. That’s the win. The person changed and the verb didn’t flinch.

Track 5 — I or You

Teacher: Now we swap only the front.

Teacher: “I want water.”

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ omi.

Teacher: Good. Mo fẹ omi.

Teacher: “You want water.”

[pause]

Student: O fẹ omi.

Teacher: Good. O fẹ omi. Same ending. Same verb. Different front.

Teacher: “I want food.”

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ oúnjẹ.

Teacher: Good. Mo fẹ oúnjẹ.

Teacher: “You want food.”

[pause]

Student: O fẹ oúnjẹ.

Teacher: Good. O fẹ oúnjẹ.

Possible learner mistake: O fẹ to jẹun.

Teacher: If you catch English trying to add “to” later, the fix is the same as before. Front, frame, ending. O fẹ jẹun.

Track 6 — Actions

Teacher: Let’s use actions now.

Teacher: “I want to sleep.”

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ sùn.

Teacher: Good. Mo fẹ sùn.

Teacher: “You want to sleep.”

[pause]

Student: O fẹ sùn.

Teacher: Good. O fẹ sùn. You changed mo to o; everything else survived.

Teacher: “I want to go.”

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ lọ.

Teacher: Good. Mo fẹ lọ.

Teacher: “You want to go.”

[pause]

Student: O fẹ lọ.

Teacher: Good. O fẹ lọ.

Teacher: “I want to eat.”

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ ọjun.

Teacher: Good. Mo fẹ ọjun.

Teacher: “You want to eat.”

[pause]

Student: O fẹ ọjun.

Teacher: Very good. O fẹ ọjun. That is the frame becoming flexible.

Track 7 — Not a Question Yet

Teacher: A little aside, because English may be getting impatient.

Teacher: “You want water” is a statement. We are not asking “Do you want water?” yet.

Teacher: That question is coming. But if we bring it in now, it will steal attention from today’s job.

Teacher: Today’s job is simpler and deeper: change the person at the front.

Teacher: Mo fẹ omi.

Teacher: O fẹ omi.

Teacher: That’s enough for one clean thought.

Track 8 — Front and Ending

Teacher: Think of two places.

Teacher: The front tells us who.

Teacher: The ending tells us what is wanted.

Teacher: Build “you want money.”

[pause]

Student: O fẹ owó.

Teacher: Good. O fẹ owó. Now “I want money.”

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ owó.

Teacher: Good. Mo fẹ owó.

Teacher: “You want to come.”

[pause]

Student: O fẹ wá.

Teacher: Good. O fẹ wá.

Teacher: “I want to come.”

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ wá.

Teacher: Good. Mo fẹ wá. Your mind is learning where the moving parts are.

Track 9 — Final Round

Teacher: Final round. I will mix I and familiar you.

Teacher: “You want food.”

[pause]

Student: O fẹ oúnjẹ.

Teacher: Good. O fẹ oúnjẹ.

Teacher: “I want to go.”

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ lọ.

Teacher: Good. Mo fẹ lọ.

Teacher: “You want water.”

[pause]

Student: O fẹ omi.

Teacher: Good. O fẹ omi.

Teacher: “I want to eat.”

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ jẹun.

Teacher: Good. Mo fẹ ẹun.

Teacher: “You want to sleep.”

[pause]

Student: O fẹ sùn.

Teacher: Good. O fẹ sùn.

Teacher: “I want money.”

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ owó.

Teacher: Good. Mo fẹ owó. You changed the front without breaking the sentence.

Track 10 — Close

Teacher: Today we added one small word and opened a lot of space.

Teacher: Mo fẹ. I want.

Teacher: O fẹ. You want.

Teacher: Fẹ stayed the same.

Teacher: Next lesson we meet a word that sounds dangerously close to o, but sits higher in the voice. This is where tone stops being an idea and becomes something you can feel.

Words Taught

Yoruba	Meaning
o	you, singular informal/familiar

Lesson 4

Script

Track 1 — Rebuild I and You

Teacher: Welcome back. Let’s wake up the frame.

Teacher: “I want water.”

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ omi.

Teacher: Good. Mo fẹ omi. “You want water.”

[pause]

Student: O fẹ omi.

Teacher: Good. O fẹ omi.

Teacher: “I want to sleep.”

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ sùn.

Teacher: Good. Mo fẹ sùn.

Teacher: “You want to sleep.”

[pause]

Student: O fẹ sùn.

Teacher: Good. O fẹ sùn. Mo at the front for I. O at the front for familiar you.

Teacher: Today we keep that same frame, but your ear has to do slightly finer work.

Track 2 — Listen Before Meaning

Teacher: Listen first. Don’t translate yet.

Teacher: O.

Teacher: Ó.

Teacher: Again.

Teacher: O.

Teacher: Ó.

Teacher: The mouth shape is almost the same. The place in the voice is not.

Teacher: O sits in the middle. Ó sits higher.

Teacher: Try them slowly.

Student: O. Ó.

Teacher: Good. O. Ó. If you slid upward like a little question, try again more simply. Land in the middle: o. Land higher: ó.

Track 3 — The New Front

Teacher: You already know o as familiar “you.”

Teacher: The higher one, **ó**, means he, she, or it.

Teacher: Listen again with meaning now.

Teacher: O. You.

Teacher: Ó. He, she, or it.

Teacher: Say them.

Student: O. Ó.

Teacher: Good. O. Ó. This is why we did not want to rush tone. Here it earns its keep.

Track 4 — He or She Wants

Teacher: Build this carefully.

Teacher: If o fẹ is “you want,” how would you say “he wants”?

[pause]

Student: Ó fẹ.

Teacher: Yes. Ó fẹ.

Teacher: What changed?

[pause]

Student: The front.

Teacher: Good. The front. What stayed still?

[pause]

Student: Fẹ.

Teacher: Exactly. Fẹ. English says he wants. Yoruba here keeps fẹ still. The verb doesn’t flinch.

Teacher: And “she wants”?

[pause]

Student: Ó fẹ.

Teacher: Good. Ó fẹ. Same Yoruba. Context will tell us whether we mean he or she.

Track 5 — You or He

Teacher: Now we make the contrast work.

Teacher: Listen to the English prompt. Decide whether the front is o or ó.

Teacher: “You want water.”

[pause]

Student: O fẹ omi.

Teacher: Good. O fẹ omi. Middle voice at the front.

Teacher: “He wants water.”

[pause]

Student: Ó fẹ omi.

Teacher: Good. Ó fẹ omi. Higher at the front.

Possible learner mistake: O fẹ omi.

Teacher: If you said o fẹ omi for “he wants water,” the structure was fine. Only the pitch picked the wrong person. That is a good kind of mistake: small, audible, fixable. Ó fẹ omi.

Teacher: “You want food.”

[pause]

Student: O fẹ óúnjẹ.

Teacher: Good. O fẹ óúnjẹ.

Teacher: “She wants food.”

[pause]

Student: Ó fẹ óúnjẹ.

Teacher: Good. Ó fẹ óúnjẹ.

Track 6 — Three Fronts

Teacher: Now we have three fronts.

Teacher: Mo. I.

Teacher: O. You.

Teacher: Ó. He or she.

Teacher: Say them slowly.

Student: Mo. O. Ó.

Teacher: Good. Mo. O. Ó. Not a chant, not a song. Just three small words with three jobs.

Teacher: “I want money.”

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ owó.

Teacher: Good. Mo fẹ owó.

Teacher: “You want money.”

[pause]

Student: O fẹ owó.

Teacher: Good. O fẹ owó.

Teacher: “She wants money.”

[pause]

Student: Ó fẹ owó.

Teacher: Good. Ó fẹ owó. You changed the person and the rest of the sentence stayed calm.

Track 7 — English Wants to Change the Verb

Teacher: English is going to make one more suggestion now.

Teacher: I want.

Teacher: You want.

Teacher: He wants.

Teacher: English changes want to wants.

Teacher: Yoruba does not need that here.

Teacher: Mo fẹ.

Teacher: O fẹ.

Teacher: Ó fẹ.

Teacher: Same fẹ every time.

Teacher: That is a relief. Take the relief where the language gives it to you.

Track 8 — Actions

Teacher: Now with actions.

Teacher: “I want to sleep.”

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ sùn.

Teacher: Good. Mo fẹ sùn.

Teacher: “You want to sleep.”

[pause]

Student: O fẹ sùn.

Teacher: Good. O fẹ sùn.

Teacher: “She wants to sleep.”

[pause]

Student: Ó fẹ sùn.

Teacher: Good. Ó fẹ sùn. Hear that high front and low ending: ó ... sùn.

Teacher: “He wants to go.”

[pause]

Student: Ó fẹ lọ.

Teacher: Good. Ó fẹ lọ.

Teacher: “You want to go.”

[pause]

Student: O fẹ lọ.

Teacher: Good. O fẹ lọ.

Teacher: “I want to go.”

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ lọ.

Teacher: Good. Mo fẹ lọ.

Track 9 — It

Teacher: Ó can also mean it.

Teacher: We do not need much of that yet, and I don’t want it stealing the lesson. But you should hear the possibility.

Teacher: “It wants water.”

[pause]

Student: Ó fẹ omi.

Teacher: Good. Ó fẹ omi. Same Yoruba sentence as “he wants water” or “she wants water.” Context does the choosing.

Teacher: We will leave it there for now. Touched, not unpacked.

Track 10 — Final Round

Teacher: Final round. This is ear work and structure work together.

Teacher: “You want to eat.”

[pause]

Student: O fẹ ọrun.

Teacher: Good. O fẹ ọrun.

Teacher: “She wants to eat.”

[pause]

Student: Ó fẹ ọrun.

Teacher: Good. Ó fẹ ọrun. Tiny pitch difference, big meaning difference.

Teacher: “I want water.”

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ omi.

Teacher: Good. Mo fẹ omi.

Teacher: “He wants food.”

[pause]

Student: Ó fẹ ọ́nṣẹ.

Teacher: Good. Ó fẹ ọ́nṣẹ.

Teacher: “You want to come.”

[pause]

Student: O fẹ wá.

Teacher: Good. O fẹ wá.

Teacher: “I want to sleep.”

[pause]

Student: Mo fẹ sùn.

Teacher: Good. Mo fẹ sùn.

Teacher: “She wants money.”

[pause]

Student: Ó fẹ owó.

Teacher: Very good. Ó fẹ owó. You held the frame, changed the front, and listened for pitch. That’s real work.

Track 11 — Close

Teacher: This first little arc has given you a working engine.

Teacher: Mo fẹ. I want.

Teacher: O fẹ. You want.

Teacher: Ó fẹ. He wants. She wants. It wants.

Teacher: Same verb. Different front.

Teacher: And today the difference between o and ó was not decoration. It was grammar. Your voice carried meaning.

Teacher: That is a good place to stop.

Words Taught

Yoruba Meaning

ó	he/she/it
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